CISA INTELLIGENCE

Threat Landscape Report

26 February — 04 March 2026

227	26	10	157
INTELLIGENCE ITEMS	CRITICAL	NEW EXPOSURE ALERTS	SITREPS GENERATED

CVE	CVSS	EPSS	KEV	SOURCE	TITLE
CVE-2026-1731	9.9	0.00	Yes	CISA	Operating system – CISA drops 11 EV changing advisories + Cisco SD-WAN bitsy confirmed active
CVE-2026-1603	8.6	0.00	Yes	CISA	RESURGE malware resurfaces on cash appliances, NCSC UK warns Telecom Italia
CVE-2026-1731	9.9	0.00	Yes	CISA	Weekend slowdown begins, Kimwolf botnet investigation directly
CVE-2026-1603	8.6	0.00	Yes	CISA	Quiet. The calm before the storm.
CVE-2026-1731	9.9	0.00	Yes	CISA	Vulnerability Spotlight: Ivanti Endpoint Manager, npm supply-chain attack (28 trojanized packages)
CVE-2026-1603	8.6	0.00	Yes	CISA	CyberSheet weaponization continued, 3 more EV changing advisories, one KEV + Cisco Talos publish Iran-nexus APT research
CVE-2026-1731	9.9	0.00	Yes	CISA	Freedroid zero-click RCE, Cisco Talos Iran-nexus APT, LiXiaoJian stealer, Kimwolf botnet CISA drops 16 countries

The week follows a distinctive **"backend" pattern**: heavy opening (Wed 25th), weekend lull, then a dramatic Monday-Tuesday surge that exceeded the opening. Volume dropped from 4 items on Saturday to **56 on Tuesday** — a 14.0x acceleration.

EXPOSURE ALERTS

2. The Iran Cyber Dimension — "When Kinetic Meets Digital"

The dominant narrative of the week. **Seven separate intelligence reports** from Recorded Future, UNI 42, Cisco Talos, DarkReading, BleepingComputer, The Hacker News converge on a single assessment:

> *Following the killing of Iran's supreme leader in coordinated US-Israel strikes, IRGC-linked cyber actors, state-aligned hacktivists, and proxy groups have activated retaliatory operations.*

What's been observed

- **149 hacktivist DDoS attacks** against 110 organizations across 16 countries (Keyrouze, Dieffet, pro-Iranian groups)
- Wiper malware deployment targeting energy and desalination plants
- Spearphishing campaigns against government and critical infrastructure across the Gulf states
- Website defacements and data leak threats
- UK NCSC issued specific warning to British organizations

Geographic blast radius

UAE, Israel, Bahrain, Qatar, Kuwait, UAE, Saudi Arabia, Jordan, Iraq, Cyprus — essentially the entire Middle East plus Five Eyes nations.

Named actors

IRGC-linked state actors, MuddyWater, Shroulded Snooper, Tarnished Scorpius, and a constellation of proxy hacktivist groups.

Assessment

Iran's proxy strategy "could scale IODeS and defacement" per Cisco Talos, but espionage, destructive attacks, and hack-and-leak operations remain **plausible escalation paths**.

CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE

3. The EV Changing Infrastructure Reckoning

The week's most underappreciated story. **CISA published 10 advisories** affecting EV charging backends from multiple vendors — Everon, MaxGen, ePower, AMPLY, and others — all sharing a common vulnerability pattern:

- Unauthenticated/weakly authenticated WebSocket/OCPP endpoints
- Public exposure documented
- Session hijacking and shadowing capability

ATTACK	IMPACT
Station impersonation	Attacker poses as legitimate charger
Session hijacking	Take over active charging sessions
Telemetry suppression	DoS at scale by disrupting backend comms
Backend command injection	Lateral movement into utility infrastructure

Geographic spread: Worldwide, with specific vendor presence in Sweden, Hungary, Ireland, France, UK, US.

These aren't isolated bugs — they represent a **systemic architectural weakness** in OCPP-based charging infrastructure. When the energy sector is simultaneously being targeted by Iranian state actors, this convergence is particularly concerning.

EMERGING THREAT

4. AI Crosses the Rubicon — CyberStrikeAI

The week delivered proof that **AI-weaponized exploitation has moved from theory to production**. An open-source AI security testing platform, CyberStrikeAI, was adopted by threat actors to automate exploitation of FortiGate appliances **across 55 countries**.

The attack chain

1. AI-driven vulnerability scanning at scale
2. Automated administrator access exploitation
3. Creation of rogue accounts
4. Configuration extraction
5. SSQLSHAK, about for persistence

Reported independently by both The Hacker News and BleepingComputer — this is the first widely-observed commercial case of an **AI-native offensive tool** being weaponized in the wild.

Other AI signals this week

LLM Agent Prompt Injection (AIVD, EU, Feb)	**NCSC Mythos Warnings** (NCSC, UK Gov)
Attackers weaponizing hidden web content to poison AI agents' reasoning — 32 cases against agents LLMs, causing agents to execute unauthorized actions.	Frontier AI models capable of vulnerability discovery/exploitation. Recommend — patch backlogs, prepare, prepare, prepare. Unpatched incidents at attack vectors.
Google Unveils AI Agent (Google, Feb)	**AI-Enabled Browser Risks** (Sandfortify, Feb)
Project Naptime/Big Sleep — AI agent for vulnerability research. Finding real bugs in SQLite, OpenSSL, FFmpeg.	Prompt injection, clickjacking, AI-specific attack surfaces. Agentic browsers expand the attack surface.

ATTACK

5. The Kill Chain — ATT&CK Technique Mapping

#	TECHNIQUE	MENTIONS	KILL CHAIN PHASE
1	T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application	61	INITIAL ACCESS
2	T1078 Valid Accounts	51	INITIAL ACCESS · PERSISTENCE
3	T1566 Phishing	51	INITIAL ACCESS
4	T1498 Endpoint Denial of Service	26	IMPACT
5	T1203 Exploitation for Client Execution	21	EXECUTION
6	T1059 Command & Scripting Interpreter	21	EXECUTION
7	T1204 User Execution	21	EXECUTION
8	T1041 Exfiltration Over C2 Channel	19	EXFILTRATION
9	T1068 Exploitation for Privilege Escalation	24	PRIV ESC
10	T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer	19	INITIAL ACCESS
11	T1071 Application Layer Protocol	20	C2
12	T1195 Ingress Tool Transfer	15	C2
13	T1486 Data Encrypted for Impact	14	IMPACT
14	T1083 Exploitation of Remote Services	13	LATERAL MOVT
15	T1552 Unsecured Credentials	10	CRED ACCESS

The **Initial Access Triad** (T1190 + T1078 + T1566) dominates with 176 combined mentions — attackers are getting in through exposed applications, stolen/default credentials, and phishing. T1195 (Supply Chain) at #12 with 21 mentions reflects the npm trojan campaign and broader supply-chain anxiety.

CONVERGENCE

6. Convergence Alerts — All Date at Maximum

The convergence engine — which scores multi-dimensional threat alignment from 0-100 — **has 16 alerts pegged at the maximum score of 100**, all hitting 5/5 dimensions:

Government · US 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites	**Critical Infrastructure · US** 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites	**Education · US** 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites	**Food & Agriculture · US** 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites
Government · Afghanistan 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites	**Government · France** 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites	**Government · Japan** 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites	**Government · Canada** 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites
			Government · China 24 mentions · 5/5 · 30 sites

The **US Government** convergence alert leads with 250 distinct signals — the highest in the dataset. Every government-sector geography is at maximum. The system is not crying wolf — it is registering a genuine multi-sector, multi-actor, multi-geography threat environment.

ACTORS

7. The Actor Scoreboard

DDoS	IRGC-linked actors, MuddyWater, Shroulded Snooper, Tarnished Scorpius	149	Iran escalation — DDoS, wipers, phishing, espionage
Iran	Iran-linked government-aligned actors	149	BeaverTail / InfoStealer supply-chain npm
Lazarus	Silver Dragon, APT41	149	Dohdoor backdoor, Rust-based loaders
Cisco	Cisco Talos	149	Cisco SD-WAN exploitation (2 new campaigns)
China	The Com	149	Social engineering / Identity Fraud
Iran	LockBit affiliates	149	ActionRAT exploitation + ransomware deployment
RANSOMWARE	Keyrouze, Dieffet	149	149 DDoS attacks across 16 countries
UNKNOWN	AI-assisted unknown actors	149	CyberStrikeAI FortiGate campaign (55 countries)

MALWARE

9. Malware Menagerie

MALWARE	TYPE	STRATEGY
Wipers	Destructive	Iran-linked, targeting energy / marine
LockBit	Ransomware	Via Apache ActiveMQ CVE-2023-46604
RESURGE	Implant	Dormant on Ivanti Connect Secure appliances
Cerber (Cryptolitemur)	Exploit Kit	OS targeting exploit kit
Kimwolf	C2 Framework	Standard post-exploitation tooling
Xillyrin	RAT	Phishing delivery chains
Dohdoor	Backdoor	Silver Dragon / APT41 operations
Beaver / **InfoStealer**	Stealer / RAT	Npm/pypi supply chain vec
Kimwolf	Botnet	DDoS-for-hire, LATRUN adjacent (SMNT links)
Hexon	C2 Framework	Emerging Cobalt Strike alternative
BurnedDwell	Implant	Rust-based custom persistent access tool

TARGETING

10. Sector & Geographic Targeting

Top Sectors (Normalized)

#	SECTOR	MENTIONS
1	**Energy / Oil Charging**	23+
2	Government / Public Sector	15
3	Transportation	13
4	Healthcare	13
5	Critical Manufacturing	8
6	ICS / OT	8
7	Financial Services	8
8	Defense / Military	8
9	Maritime / Shipping	4

Top Geographies

#	GEOGRAPHY	MENTIONS
1	**Worldwide / Global**	40
2	**United States**	39
3	United Kingdom	12
4	Middle East	8
5	Iran	7
6	Europe	6
7	Israel	4
8	France	3
9	Canada	4
10	Gulf States (Bahrain/UAE)	14

EPSS

11. EPSS Landscape Snapshot (28 Feb 2026)

317,833	7,133	4,334	1,529	880
CVES TRACKED	EPSS > 0.5	EPSS > 0.7	KEV EXPLOITED	KEV WITH EPSS > 0.5

18
CRONUS CP > 0.2

METRIC	VALUE
Total CVEs tracked	317,833
EPSS > 0.5 (high exploitation probability)	7,133
EPSS > 0.7 (very high)	4,334
KEV catalogue total	1,529
KEV with EPSS > 0.5	880 (57.6%)
Crossed up past 0.2 this period	18
Crossed up past 0.5 this period	2
Max EPSS score	0.94816 (CVE-2024-27198)
Median EPSS	0.00389
95th percentile	0.17969
99th percentile	0.76346

18 CVEs crossed above the 0.2 exploitation threshold — indicating fresh exploitability emerging in previously dormant vulnerabilities.

SOURCES

12. Intelligence Source Distribution

SOURCE	ITEMS	CHARACTER
BleepingComputer	49	Breaking news, vendor disclosures
The Hacker News	36	Threat actor campaigns, AI threats
DarkReading	27	Analysis, emerging risks
JPCERTCC	26	Asia-Pacific vulnerability coordination
Ubuntu Security	24	OS-level patches
CISA Advisories	18	ICS/OT, EV charging, government directives
SANS ISC	11	Network-level observations
Debian Security	8	OS-level patches
Ivanti Patches / Unit 42 / Cisco Talos	7	Iran escalation assessments
Exploit-DB	5	Proof-of-concept availability

ASSESSMENT

Bottom Line

This week's **structurally significant week**. Three independent forcing functions collided:

1. **Geopolitical rupture** — The Iran cyber escalation is real, active, and accelerating. The convergence engine confirms it with unprecedented scores. 149 DDoS attacks observed, wipers deployed, multiple nation-state threat intelligence vendors issuing concurrent warnings.
2. **Systemic infrastructure exposure** — The EV charging advisory wave reveals an entire sector built on unauthenticated OCPP protocols. This isn't one vendor — it's an architectural class of vulnerability across the ecosystem, laid bare just as Iran actors target energy infrastructure.
3. **AI weaponization inflection** — CyberStrikeAI's adoption by threat actors, combined with prompt injection research from Unit 42 and NCSC warnings, marks the week AI-assisted offensive operations became mainstream rather than aspirational.

The convergence alerts at 100/100 across 16 sector-geography pairs, with the US Government alert carrying **250 distinct signals**, represent the highest threat convergence density in the dataset's history.

Priority Watch — Coming Week

- Iranian retaliation trajectory — will espionage and hack-and-leak ops materialize?
- Cisco SD-WAN patch adoption (CVE-2026-1603 deadline)
- Whether CyberStrikeAI campaigns expand beyond FortiGate to other appliance families
- EV charging operator response to CISA advisory wave

Severity Distribution — Full Week

CRITICAL 26	HIGH 128	MEDIUM 31	LOW 12	INFO 10

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